New Zealand Rogaining Association AGM,
Monday 22 February 2010, 6 Harrods Court, Christchurch

Present: Trevor Merrifield, Bill Kennedy, Grant Hunter, Peter Squires, Tim Farrant, Phil Bones, Dave Laurie, Emma De Lacey, Mike Sheridan (Skype)
Apologies: Nick Collins, Nora Audra, Ian Edmond

Minutes of AGM 2009: Moved that minutes are accepted: PS/TM

Matters arising
Nil

Election of Officers

President: Peter Squires (EdL/DL)
Secretary: Grant Hunter (PS/EdL)
Treasurer: Trevor Merrifield (PS/DL)
Committee: Phil Bones (EdL/BK), Dave Laurie (TM/PS), Emma De Lacey (DL/PB), Bill Kennedy (PS/TM), Tim Farrant (BK/PS) Mike Sheridan (PS/EdL), Nick Collins (GH/DL), Alan Holdaway (TM/PS)

Committee places filled were in excess of the three required in the Rules.
With no nominations exceeding places to be filled there was no voting.

Technical roles:

Webmaster and membership: Bill Kennedy
Navlight: Jac Woudberg
Gear controller and Assets: Dave Laurie

IRF Representatives: Alan Holdaway, Nick Collins

Regional representatives:

Auckland –Shaun Collins
Taranaki – Annie Sanderson
Bay of Plenty – Mark Copeland
Wellington – Mike Sheridan, Jamie Stewart
Marlborough – Alan Holdaway, Mondo Kopua
Central Otago – Ed Stevens
Otago – Bob Cunninghame

President's report

Presented

Financial report

Accounts for 2009 were accepted as presented (PS/GH)

Discussion: Dave Laurie expressed concern that the Association was accumulating financial assets, rather than retaining a modest and stable bank balance and investing the remainder back into developing rogaining. (See item in general business)

Notice of motion
That NZRA holds a general meeting at the National Championship rogaine each year, with a pre-notified agenda. The NZRA management will review the minutes and outcomes of this meeting, and engage with membership on significant issues or recommendations.

Proposed: Grant Hunter
Seconded: Pete Squires

Explanation
As noted in the minutes of the AGM 2009, the committee of NZRA is looking at ways to operate more effectively at a truly national level. It has been suggested that a further step would be to hold the AGM at the annual National Championship event, to stimulate wider national involvement and to involve active rogainers who would not otherwise attend an AGM (irrespective of location). This also has difficulties and limitations. The proposal above is offered as an alternative practical step towards improved national functioning.

Discussion at AGM
Agreed that the Nat champs was not a suitable venue for the AGM, but that a meeting of some sort should be held in conjunction with it. Two points raised: (1) agreed that this meeting should be a 'forum', rather than a GM, the latter being a formal meeting that could take decisions for the Association. There should be an opportunity to post agenda items prior to the meeting, and the meeting should be chaired by a committee member or a delegated person. (2) Timing – after the event while awaiting prize giving was judged more likely to be attractive for members to attend rather than the previous evening. (Noted that for nat champs organised by NZOF, permission will be sought from that organisation.)

Revised notice was passed unanimously:
"That NZRA holds a forum-type meeting at the National Championship rogaine each year, with opportunity for a pre-notified agenda. The NZRA management will review the minutes and outcomes of this meeting, and engage with membership on significant issues or recommendations."

General business

Nominations and voting by Internet?

- Do-able but tricky – needs good security to ensure 1 person/1vote. Especially tricky with our 'open' membership. Voting software is available.
- Nominations need to be in well in advance - difficult to get this.
- Not judged to be worthwhile or critical at this stage, but keep an open mind as the Association further develops.

NZ ChampionshipRogaine, 17-18 April, Akatarawa Ranges, Orienteering Hutt Valley
Mike Sheridan reported that things are progressing OK at this stage. He will shortly prepare a media release. Dave Laurie to follow up recovery of trophies from last year. May need a marquee as there are no suitable structures at the start/finish. Suggested to try a regional rural supplies company for a loaned one.

World Championship (WRC2010), 20/21 November)
Things progressing well. Of 80 landowners contacted nearly all are enabling access. Most check points have been provisionally placed. 40 entries of 550 not yet finally confirmed.

Financial support for elite individuals/teams competing internationally
The Association has been approached to provide financial support for a team for the Australian Champs. We do not have a policy that supports this, and there are many ways of dealing with it. The Association is not prepared to oblige at this time but the idea has merit and it has got us thinking. Tim Farrant and Dave Laurie to consider options, and to draft a set of criteria for NZRA to consider. (This leads on to next item)

Association finances
Dave Laurie pointed out that NZRA financial assets continue to grow modestly each year and he is concerned that the Association does not allocate more towards support and development of rogaining. There was overall empathy for this view. Off-the-cuff options for such investment included support for elite teams, lower cost or free events, equipment purchase, reduced insurance levies on events supported by NZRA.

New Equipment

- Agree to review needs for flags, tracking GPS, etc and for committee to purchase as needed.
- Purchase OCAD 9 professional mapping software agreed, subject to Bill confirming its utility value (PS/BM).

Membership and list
The electronic membership list of NZRA comprises two components: those who 'join the association' and those who become members through entering an event. Since there is no annual subscription-based or other renewal process to refresh lists, it is hard to keep lists current. There are also practical difficulties accessing and including entry lists from events supported for insurance purposes by NZRA. Bill Kennedy and Tim Farrant will look at options for remedy.

Meeting closed.